

TV SHOW

Umbrella Academy S2

★★★★☆ | Season Two of the Umbrella Academy gets off to a much better start than the first. We had a lot of character building in Season One and that did go overboard making the initial episodes of the series seem stretched beyond necessary. With all that out of the way, Season Two takes off right from the time jump scene where Number Five tries to save his family. While Number Five might have spent a lot more years on earth with plenty of time to perfect his skills, it would appear he wasn't quite successful in that department and goofs up, yet again. This time, his siblings are brought to the same place but across different points of time. And the apocalypse



seems to have followed them. So the overarching plot remains the same, it's just that the Umbrella Academy is now in a different time and they have to tread on sensitive ground since the folks in

1960s aren't as welcoming of "others". The Commission has changed with some management reshuffle, so The Handler has her hands full for a while. However, her struggles are made simpler with the introduction of a new character. With most TV shows and movies that deal with time, the sequels usually indulge in a lot of retconning in order to tie loose ends and fill up plot holes. That doesn't seem to be the case with The Umbrella Academy, at least, not thus far. We can thank the existing comic books for that and hopefully, we shouldn't have any problems up until the showrunners run out of material. After that, they can either gracefully end the show or go the D&D way and mess it all up. The season ends on a sombre note for all of five minutes before transitioning into a cliffhanger for the next season. If you've read the comic books, you'd know exactly what comes next but for the rest of us, The Umbrella Academy is a good example of a comic-to-TV adaptation that hasn't screwed up.

MOVIE

Project Power

★★★★☆ | Piling onto the numerous superpower features that Netflix is already pumping out, their latest project initially felt like just another recycled variant. Little did we know, this time around, things were different. This time, those so-called "powers" were consumable.

Directed by Henry Joost and Ariel Schuman, Project Power follows the story of a former soldier, who is on a mission to track down the source of a mysterious drug that grants superpowers to its users. In the process, he befriends a resilient cop and a misguided drug peddler who help him overcome the demons from his past and complete his task. Watching the film, it is quite clear that it is trying its best to be a comic book movie. And it does succeed in that area. Although, only visually, owing to its stunningly beautiful cinematography. Just like how in a real comic book there are several panels that narrate a course



of action, here, it makes use of countless camera angles. Of which, none of them ever feel repetitive or overbearing and are all cut and stitched together in perfect sync. Adding on, the action sequences are nicely choreographed as well, keeping in line with the film's rapid pace.

However, the film's grandeur that is, the flashiness, is marred by its subpar

writing. The base idea, which is actually an intriguing concept, is filled with corny dialogues, predictable events and is basically wrapped within a pretty generic plot. It is a sad sight to see, considering the actors – Jamie Foxx, Joseph Gordon-Levitt and Dominique Fishback, all despite having given worthy performances, suffered from some form of collateral damage, due to the flawed script. For example, Jamie's character (Art) is introduced as someone with a deep emotional backstory, fueled by vendetta. But those emotions are not conveyed well due to lack of in-depth lore. Similarly, the villains in this movie are also deprived of proper character development. Due to which they end up feeling like an almost stupid, cheap parody version of some other classic supervillain.

In conclusion, Project Power shows great potential to form its own, standalone comic book universe. It ticks all the right checkboxes to provide an appealing eye-candy experience. Despite having a mediocre storyline, the film could have done seemingly better if only it had taken its sweet time to brew up. Overall, an entertaining affair!